scores of Yugoslavs, particularly from the southern parts of the country, who were easily recognised by the large plastic bags they carried to their cars and buses. Although they were fuelling the local economy (this was one of the reasons for the lack of enthusiasm for a democratic and independent Slovenia among some in Trieste/Trst, for whom it meant a loss of business), their shabby image, together with old ethnic prejudices from the Fascist era, made them targets of contempt for local right-wing groups and wider. These became even more convinced of their racial superiority over the 'Slavs', a term they indistinguishably used for Slovenians, Croats and all other Yugoslavs in the Trieste version of the 'Eastern Europeans' label.

On the other hand, 'Eastern Europe' was a good bargain for Yugoslavs in those times, and long weekends in Prague or Bratislava by coach were very popular. People brought back large quantities of fine Czech china and other goods. As a thriving economy before World War II, the Czech Republic was particularly badly hit by Communist economic policies when compared with other nations.

On the other hand, Czechoslovakia and Poland had strong opposition movements in the final decades of Communism. Intellectuals and students were meeting in private homes or in semi-private offices and cafés to hold lively discussions about every possible political issue, sometimes supported by Western intellectuals courageous enough to venture beyond the Iron Curtain – Roger Scruton was one of them. Writers and other intellectuals were spearheading democratisation in all Eastern European countries – this was almost a cultural revolution.

Interestingly enough, this did not occur on the same scale and intensity in relatively well-off Slovenia. There, a much more sophisticated socialist regime cleverly propelled to the fore a generation that had succeeded the warriors of the revolution, hoping that letting them indulge in arts and civil initiatives short of demands for democratic changes would prevent the return of a 'bourgeois' democracy and 'reactionary' mainstream art and civil society. This too had some specific consequences for Slovenian transition.

There is one more concept that needs to be included in a full picture of Communist Eastern Europe – that of the diaspora: the emigrants. As mentioned earlier, many anti-Communists of different colours – like Karl